
BEFORE THE IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE

Re:	)	CASE NO. 17-0068
Mental Health Counselor License of	)	
	)	
STACIE MITCHELL	)	COMBINED STATEMENT OF
License No. 00967	)	CHARGES, SETTLEMENT
Respondent.	)	AGREEMENT, AND FINAL ORDER
	)	

COME NOW the Iowa Board of Behavioral Science ("Board") and Stacie Mitchell ("Respondent"), 3453 Laurel Ln, Marion IA 52302, and enter into this Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order ("Order") pursuant to Iowa Code sections 17A.10 and 272C.3(4) (2017), and 645 IAC chapter 12. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this case pursuant to Iowa Code chapters 17A, 147, 154D, and 272C, and 645 IAC chapter 33.

A. STATEMENT OF CHARGES

Count I

1. Respondent is charged with engaging in a sexual or romantic relationship with a former client within the five years following termination of the client relationship in violation of section A.5.c. of the ACA Code of Ethics (2014) entitled "Sexual and/or Romantic Relationships with Former Clients", and may be disciplined pursuant to Iowa Code section 147.55(9) and 645 IAC 33.2(1)(b) and 33.2(30)(b).

B. FACTUAL CIRCUMSTANCES

2. Respondent's license number 00967 to practice as a mental health counselor is currently active through September 30, 2018.

3. Respondent began providing family therapy to a parent and child in the summer of 2015.

4. Respondent subsequently entered into a romantic relationship with the parent.

C. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND FINAL ORDER

5. The Board has jurisdiction over the parties and the subject matter of these proceedings.

6. Respondent admits the allegations in the Statement of Charges and acknowledges that the allegations, if proven in a contested case hearing, would constitute grounds for the discipline agreed to in this Order.

7. Execution of this Order constitutes the resolution of a contested case. Respondent has a right to hearing before the Board on the charges, but Respondent waives the right to hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to appeal or seek judicial review of the Board's action, by freely and voluntarily entering into this Order. Once entered, this Order shall have the force and

effect of a disciplinary order entered following a contested case hearing.

8. Respondent acknowledges that she has the right to be represented by counsel on this matter.

9. Respondent agrees that the State's counsel may present this Order to the Board and may have *ex parte* communications with the Board while presenting it.

10. This Order is subject to approval by a majority of the full Board. If the Board does not approve this Order, it shall be of no force or effect to either party, and shall not be admissible for any purpose in further proceedings in this matter. If the Board approves this Order, it shall be the full and final resolution of this matter.

11. This Order shall be part of Respondent's permanent record and shall be considered by the Board in determining the nature and severity of any disciplinary action to be imposed in the event of any future violations.

12. This Order shall not be binding as to any new complaints received by the Board.

13. Respondent understands the Board is required by federal law to report any adverse action to the National Practitioner Data Bank.

14. This Order, when fully executed, is a public record and is available for inspection and copying in accordance with the requirements of Iowa Code chapters 22 and 272C.

15. The Board's approval of this Order shall constitute a **FINAL ORDER** of the Board.

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED:

16. Respondent agrees to **VOLUNTARILY SURRENDER** her mental health counselor license to resolve this matter. This voluntary surrender is considered discipline and, when accepted by the Board, has the same force and effect as an order of revocation under 645 IAC 12.1(5).

17. Respondent agrees not to use any words or titles which imply or represent that she is a licensed mental health counselor, or to otherwise hold herself out to the public as a licensed mental health counselor, or to engage in the practice of mental health counseling for which a license is required in the State of Iowa.

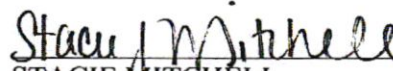
18. Respondent shall surrender her mental health counselor license to the Board immediately upon the Board's approval of this Order.

19. Respondent may not request reinstatement for at least one year from the date of this Order. Prior to seeking reinstatement, Respondent must undergo a comprehensive mental health and boundaries evaluation with a Board-approved evaluator. Respondent shall seek approval from the Board of the evaluator prior to undergoing the evaluation and shall contact the Board to have the file sent to the evaluator prior to the evaluation. The evaluation must address Respondent's ability to safely practice as a licensed mental health counselor. Respondent may

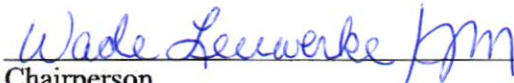
request reinstatement by filing an application for reinstatement under 645 IAC 11.31 and 31.17. Respondent's license shall not be reinstated except upon a showing by Respondent that the basis for revocation of her license no longer exists, and that it is in the public interest for the license to be reinstated.

20. Should Respondent violate the terms of this Order, the Board may initiate action to impose other licensee discipline as authorized by Iowa Code chapters 147, 154D, and 272C and 645 IAC chapters 13 and 33.

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is voluntarily submitted by Respondent to the Board for its consideration on the 17 day of May, 2017.


STACIE MITCHELL
Respondent

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is approved by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Science on the 17th day of May, 2017.


Vice-Chairperson
Iowa Board of Behavioral Science

Copy to:

Laura Steffensmeier
Assistant Attorney General
Office of the Attorney General of Iowa
1305 E. Walnut St.
Des Moines, IA 50319
ATTORNEY FOR THE STATE